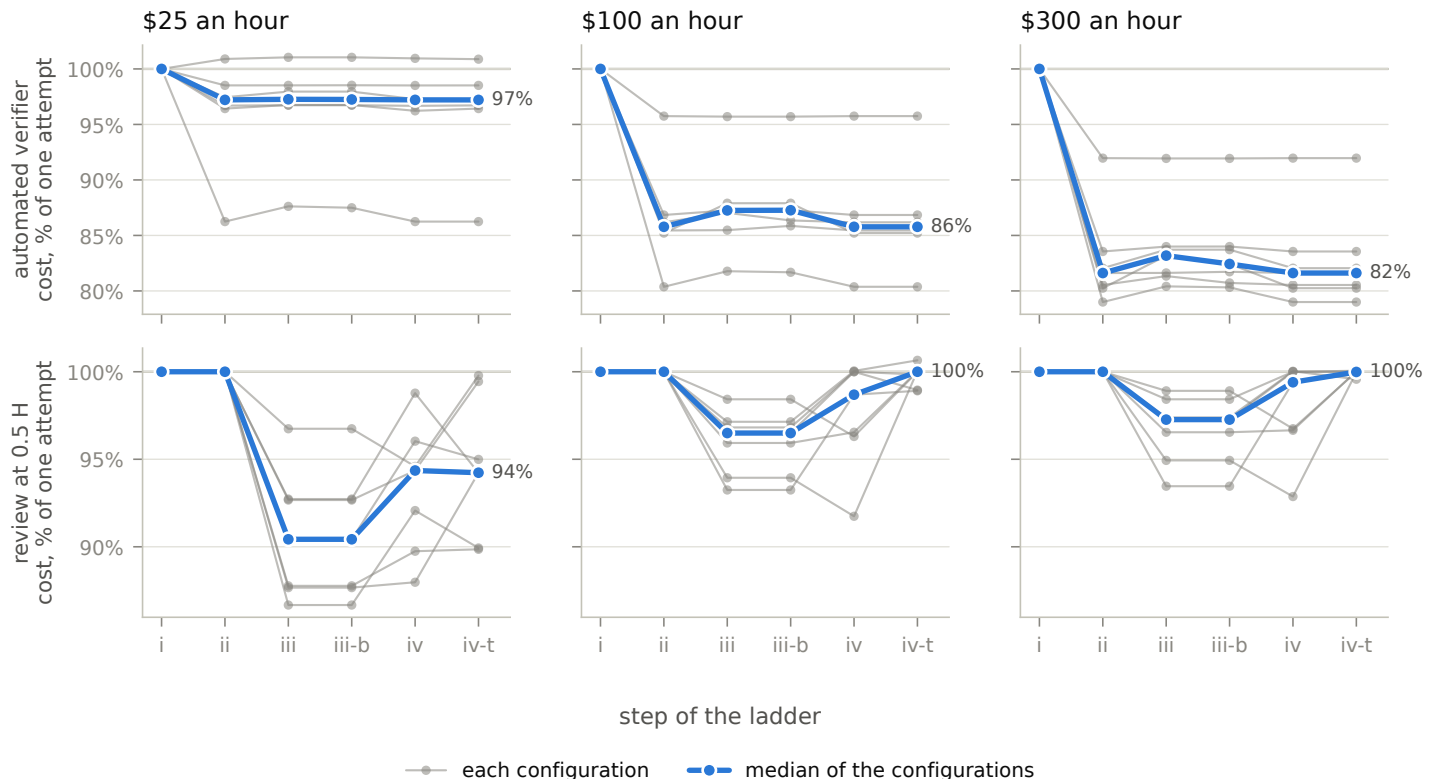


The policy ladder: expected cost at each step as a share of one attempt



Below 100%: cheaper than a single attempt followed by the outside option. iv: the state rule fitted on the configuration itself; iv-t: fitted on the other six. Every step is chosen on training folds and scored on held-out folds. † Qwen3 Coder's dollar figures rest on an imputed price (PLAN.md Section 10).